

Inclusion Event Planning Guide

Developed by
Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative



Developed in Partnership with



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Introduction

What is a Disability and What is Inclusion?

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) defines a person with a disability as one who has a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities. A major life activity includes those such as hearing, seeing, walking, standing, speaking, learning, thinking, and communicating. Disabilities can also include food allergies, cancer, depression, anxiety disorder and other mental health conditions.

- Inclusion is an attitude that honors and values every human being, without regard to ability.
- Inclusion is a process -- not an event or a special program.
- Inclusion is creating an environment in which the community goes beyond simply welcoming people with disabilities and invites those individuals to participate in every aspect of community life.
- Inclusion is doing things *with* people with disabilities, not *for* them, so that they can make decisions about how they want to participate.
- Inclusion ensures that we adapt our programs and activities so that everyone gets to participate.

Chabad's Leadership in Inclusion

Why You?

True inclusion begins with a mindset – a change in our thinking.

The Lubavitcher Rebbe OB" M pioneered this concept in its truest form, valuing every person based solely on that person's *inner* essence. The Rebbe further tasked us to make Judaism accessible to every Jew, without regard to that person's physical or spiritual status. It is the Rebbe's message of unity that has empowered Chabad to be instinctively inclusive -- to embrace each and every Jew and treat him or her like family, regardless of background or lifestyle. Chabad was already practicing inclusion before the term was even coined!

Inclusion is at the essence of Chabad philosophy and it is this deep commitment to the Inclusion of every Jew that places Chabad Lubavitch at the forefront of the message of disability Inclusion.

Why Now?

We know how to create environments that are welcoming, where people feel comfortable, no matter what their previous Jewish experiences have been. These same principles guide us to lead our broader communities in the inclusion of people with disabilities.

The Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative (RCII) and Friendship Circle International (FCI) together created this step-by-step planning and implementation guide to help you host a community-wide Inclusion Event.



The partnership between Chabad Lubavitch and the Ruderman Family Foundation, the Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative, is organic to Chabad. RCII aims to empower every one of our *Chabad communities* to create a welcoming and inclusive environment for people with disabilities in our shuls, our camps, and our schools – in every program that we offer.

We offer:

- a. Inclusion Hotline connects you to our team of experts to discuss challenges and identify solutions and answer your questions. Open daily.
- b. Resource Hub provides information about specific disabilities and resources, simple step action plans on a variety of topics from building accessibility to accommodations in all of your activities, articles and website links that connect us to the latest disability-related resources.
- c. Inclusion Event Package details the steps to take so you can create a program that raises awareness and builds community around inclusion.
- d. Guidance and training on best practices for Chabad House staff and leaders to better include people with disabilities in a deliberate way in their communities.
- e. Staff training planning and presentation. Our inclusion specialists can provide training for your staff, directors, educators and counselors.
- f. Small grants available to communities and programs to enable inclusive programming and environments. Application available upon request.

RCII is a resource for you. We invited you to contact us by email at info@rcii.org or to call us at 701-404-RCII(7244).



Friendship Circle focuses on abilities. We believe that everyone in this world is here for a unique purpose and that no two people are alike.

Friendship Circle in a local community creates meaningful relationships between teen volunteers (Teen Friends) and children with disabilities (Friends), igniting the dreams, increasing the confidence and redefining the worldviews of both.

Friendship Circle Teen Friends, with the help of their Friends, set an extraordinary example for the rest of the world, illustrating that typical teens and individuals with disabilities can have so much in common and bring out the best in each other.

Friendship Circle International invests in streamlining the successes of our 80+ regional chapters, creating a seamless force of flourishing friendship around the world.

To date over 300,000 people have been influenced by Friendship Circles worldwide, including teenage volunteers, individuals with disabilities and community members who understand the importance of our mission.

Visit us at [FriendshipCircle.com](https://www.FriendshipCircle.com) to learn about what we are accomplishing across the globe.

Event Planning

Choosing a Keynote Speaker

A good keynote speaker is important to a successful event. They can spark interest in the event, boost attendance, increase media attention, attract vendors and, most importantly, inform, inspire and motivate the audience. These are tips to choosing just the right keynote speaker.

Tips to Choose a Keynote Speaker

1. Look for speakers who can fit the theme of your event: Inclusion Event:
 - a. Person with a disability
 - b. Parent, sibling or other family member
 - c. Professional who works for a disability or social service organization
 - d. Rabbi, educator or other Jewish professional
2. Decide if you want a local or national speaker. Speakers do not have to be celebrities. In fact, you could find someone to speak who fits your event who is just starting out as a speaker. The important thing is that they will help you accomplish your goals for the event.
3. If you don't know anyone personally, ask your colleagues to recommend speakers for your event.
4. Have you heard this person speak to a similar audience? Were they motivational, inspirational, factual, humorous or informational? How did the audience respond? You want your audience to be engaged with this speaker. If you haven't heard them speak before, ask the person for references and if available, a video of them speaking.
5. What is the fee? Make sure that your speaker is within your budget.
6. Is the speaker available on the date you've chosen for your event? If not, are you able to change the date to get the right speaker?
7. A speaker should be knowledgeable about your event and what you want participants to learn and leave with and then follow-through to convey those messages in the speech. Will the speaker have a planning meeting with you so that you can share that information with them?

Event Planning Checklist

✓	Event Planning Assignments	Timeline	Person/s Responsible
	Confirm event date and time. Check Jewish community calendar to avoid conflicting events.	3+ months	
	Develop a budget. Template provided.	3+ months	
	Reserve event location.	3+ months	
	Contact potential sponsors, if needed.	3+ months	
	Identify target audiences to promote the event.	3+ months	
	Identify and confirm speaker(s).	3+ months	
	Arrange lodging for out of town speaker.	3+ months	
	Invite vendors from organizations in your community to host resource tables. Charge fee, if appropriate.	3+ months	
	Invite local rabbis by email and/or phone calls to put on their busy calendars.	3+ months	
	Invite local clergy and colleagues from other faith communities, and government officials.	3+ months	
	Send information to Federation to post on community calendar.	3+ months	
	Create/Print flyer/poster – For print and social Media (Facebook, Instagram, Twitter).	2+ months	
	Post event in newsletters and/or on website, Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, etc. Create hashtag.	2+ months	
	Email flyer to your email list.	2+ months	
	Recruit volunteers to assist with marketing and assist with event.	2+ months	
	Draft program agenda.	2+ months	
	Book a caterer/ bake for event.	3 months	

	Distribute (again) event flyers, posters, mailing, post on social media.	2 months	
	Rent chairs, tables, projector or other equipment as needed.	2 months	
	Write and send press release to local Jewish and secular media.	4 weeks	
	Finalize presentation, if needed.	4 weeks	
	Finalize volunteer schedule & tasks for event.	3 weeks	
	Make phone calls to key people you want to attend.	3 weeks	
	Review AV needs and confirm reservations.	3 weeks	
	Confirm vendors.	3 weeks	
	Print final program, if needed.	1 week	
	Print handouts, if needed.	1 week	
	Make a sign in sheet for the contact info of participants.	1 week	
	Finalize and confirm refreshments.	1 week	

	Remind vendors to send out the flyer again to their constituents and to post it on social media.	1 week	
	Print name badges, if needed.	1 week	
	Make signs to direct attendees to event location/room.	1 day	
	Set up event location, registration area, presentation space, food and beverage tables, put up signs, etc.	1 day	
	Print an 8 1/2x11 page for each vendor and put in on their table so they know where to set up.	1 day	
	After event		
	Have participants fill in Event Evaluation Form.	At event	
	Email survey to participants (optional).	1 week after event	
	Follow-up Press Release with event details.	1 week after event	
	Send event summary evaluation to RCII.	Within 2 wks	

Inclusion Event Planning Considerations

- Choose a day and time that will bring people from the community to the event and won't conflict with programming in the community, such as Hebrew school. Some communities host events on Sunday afternoons or evenings and others have had successful turnouts by combining an inclusion event with a *Havdalah* service with activities.
- Advertise your inclusion event to your entire community, and encourage people with disabilities and their families to attend. Include people with disabilities in planning for the event—"Nothing about us without us!"
- Include language that encourages people to contact you if they require an accommodation. This is recommended language:

Every Chabad community is committed to creating an inclusive and welcoming environment. If you require an accommodation in order to attend please contact (name) at (phone number) by (insert a due date so that you have time to make the arrangements).

- Arrange for an American Sign Language (ASL) interpreter to be at your event, if requested.
- Ensure that people who use wheelchairs, walkers and canes can access the event space and restrooms.
- Make sure that handouts are available in alternative formats such as large print and Braille, if requested.
- Offer a quiet space during your event and let people know they are welcome to use it when necessary.
- Invite and encourage every organization in your community to attend because this discussion affects everyone.
- Invite a guest speaker who has a disability to speak to your audience. You can ask your local Arc, state parent training center, state governors council on disability or disability organization to provide a guest speaker if you don't know someone personally.
- Invite related organizations to be vendors at the event. This can provide income with a fee per table to pay for the event as well as increase publicity if they share the event with their constituents. You can provide tables for display, flyers to distribute electronically to their constituents, and include them in your social media. Vendors must be present at the event to staff their tables.

➤ Organizations you want to invite (some from this list could be vendors too):

- Federation
- Jewish Community Center
- Jewish Family Service Agency
- Schools for students with disabilities
- Jewish Day Schools and Public Schools
- Hadassah and other groups from the community
- Synagogues in your community, sisterhoods and brotherhoods
- Athletic groups
- Disability benefits law firms
- Transition providers and programs
- Job coaching/employment organizations
- University disability studies departments
- Local disability organizations including: Arc, state parent training and information center, Autism Society, Down syndrome organization, etc.
- Children's Museum
- Camps
- Day care programs
- Scouting organizations and youth groups

Sample Event Budget

Inclusion Event Budget

Expenses

	Estimated	Actual
Total Expenses		\$0.00

Site	Estimated	Actual
Room and hall fees		
Site staff		
Equipment		
Tables and chairs		
Total	\$0.00	\$0.00

Decorations	Estimated	Actual
Flowers		
Candles		
Lighting		
Balloons		
Paper supplies		
Total	\$0.00	\$0.00

Publicity	Estimated	Actual
Graphic designer		
Photocopying/Printing		
Postage		
Total	\$0.00	

Miscellaneous	Estimated	Actual
Total	\$0.00	\$0.00

Refreshments	Estimated	Actual
Food		\$0.00
Drinks		
Linens		
Staff and gratuities		
Total		

Program	Estimated	Actual
Performers		
Speakers		
Travel		
Hotel		
Other		
Total	\$0.00	

Prizes	Estimated	Actual
Ribbons/Plaques/Trophies		
Gifts		
Total	\$0.00	\$0.00

Marketing Materials

Sample Flyer Copy

(see Sample Flyer jpg for design ideas)

Logo and Name of Your Organization

Inclusion Event

FREE and Open to the Public!

Date:

Time: include start and end times, Dessert Reception Following

Location:

Keynote Speaker

(Insert information, a photo, a quote and short bio about your speaker)

If you have an additional speaker include their information

Also featuring guest speaker (insert name)

Brief description of who speaker is and topic/photo

We are Chabad of/Friendship Circle of... Join us for the community-wide Inclusion Event to learn more about how you can foster meaningful inclusion of people with disabilities in all aspects of community life.

Our organization is passionate about building bridges throughout the entire community! We cordially invite the entire community to the Inclusion Event.

Please RSVP: (email address and phone number for RSVP)

If you require an accommodation in order to attend please contact (name) at (phone number) by (insert a due date so that you have time to make the arrangements).

Evening of Awareness is a joint partnership between Friendship Circle International and Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative (RCII).

Be sure to include both the Friendship Circle logo and the Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative (RCII) logo.

Sample Press Release-Pre-event

For Immediate Release

Contact:

Phone:

Contact email:

(Your Organization) HOSTS COMMUNITY INCLUSION EVENT

Your City, State – The Chabad House of/Friendship Circle of ... will host a free event, Inclusion Event on (date), (time), at (location). The event is open to the public.

The purpose of the event is to bring (name of your community or city) together to learn how we can each do more to include people with disabilities in all aspects of community life. The event will feature outstanding speakers, activities, and a dessert reception following.

The keynote speaker is (Name of speaker, name of speaker's organization, brief bio and include the title of the talk and a description of the talk).

The event also features guest speaker (Name of speaker, name of speaker's organization) who will provide information about (one sentence about what the speaker will talk about).

According to the recent U.S. Census, nearly 20% of the population has some form of disability including physical disabilities, mental health conditions, autism and allergies. Chabad of/Friendship Circle of... is hosting this event because disability affects each of us in some way. This event is open to the entire community - schools, synagogues, religious and secular organizations, friends and families.

Participants will learn how they can make a difference.

Chabad of/Friendship Circle of... is partnering with The Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative (RCII) for this event. The RCII is dedicated to helping Chabad communities become more inclusive and welcoming for people with disabilities in every part of community life by providing them with practical tools and resources.

Mission of (your organization)

is a non profit organization that (insert your mission statement here. Indicate how the Evening of Inclusion event exemplifies the mission).

Chabad of/Friendship Circle of... is passionate about building bridges throughout our community and encourages all community members to join us. Bring your friends!

To learn more about this event contact:

Name and phone number of contact:

Email of contact:

Website: for your organization

Inviting Community Vendors

Your community has numerous organizations that serve people with disabilities and their families. Inviting them to display their information and materials and to meet participants benefits everyone.

You are giving these organizations the opportunity to meet many people who may benefit from their services and programs. Asking vendors to contribute a small amount of money to participate will defray your costs for the event. \$50.00 is a reasonable amount to charge per table. Every community can determine how much to charge per table. Providing electronic flyers for them to send to their constituents and using social media to mention their participation can attract additional people to your event. The vendors will also be attending your event and learning about you and your organization.

Sample Vendor Invitation E-mail

This is a sample email that you can send to local organizations inviting them to participate in the Inclusion Event. Include a link in to the registration form (recommend using Google Docs).

Dear (Name of Organization or contact person's name):

We would like to invite you to join us as we host an Inclusion Event on (date) by hosting a table where you can promote the work of your organization and meet many people who can benefit from your services and programs.

The Inclusion Event brings together people with disabilities, family members, professionals and community members from the broader (name of your community) community to learn more about how we can all be more inclusive.

The Inclusion Event features keynote speakers including:

- Keynote speaker—with a brief description
- Name of second speaker—with a brief description

This engaging event will also feature activities, discussions, and a dessert buffet following the program.

Details:

Date, from (start time) to (end time) at (event location address, city, state, zip).
Q&A and a dessert reception to follow.

We would love for your organization to have a presence at the Inclusion Event and to share your resources with the community.

Please fill out the form below with your payment of \$(fee) to have a table at the Inclusion Event.

If you have trouble viewing or submitting this form, you can [fill it out in Google Forms](#).

(Click on the link above to see a sample form on Google Forms. You can create your own using Google Forms for online registration). There is a sample form on the next page.

Sample Vendor Registration Form

This sample registration can be created in Google Forms for online registration.

Inclusion Event Vendor Registration Form

We invite you to join us as a VENDOR at (name of organization) Inclusion Event on (Day, Date) from (start time) to (end time). Table cost \$(your fee). Set-up begins half an hour before the start of the event.

Organization Name

Contact First Name

Contact Last Name

Email Address

Phone Number

Website

Number of Representatives from your organization who will attend

Comments or questions

Method of Payment

Cost of Table is \$(your fee)

Payment Options

- ☐ **Check (mail to [your address] by (date)**
- ☐ **Credit Card**
- ☐ **PayPal**

Submit

Sample Event Schedule Breakdown and Event Detail

Approximately 75 minutes plus Dessert Reception

Have the vendors be completely set up and available to talk with participants at least 20 minutes before the event starts.

10 minutes before scheduled start time play the Yaakov Shwekey music video "I Can Be" and Matisyahu DeScribe "Pure Soul" video which are looped on You Tube with this link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C3nF2KHmQ60&list=PLorf09XcaQQaqi6R0gxnJu4l1RaG3GZNN>

5 minutes. Welcome and Introductions

5 minutes. Vendor, sponsor, volunteer and staff thank you's

15 minutes – Guest Speaker Disability Awareness 101

(Introduce Speaker from your community. Give a brief introduction of what the speaker is sharing and why it's important. Give a brief bio and invite them to the podium/stage area.

3 minutes – Introduction of keynote speaker

20 minutes -- Keynote Speech.

10 minutes – Awareness Quilt Pledge. This optional activity can be found in the Event Materials section of this Guide.

REMIND people to complete event evaluation forms and turn them in and to leave contact info on the sign in sheet.

Dessert Reception and Vendor tables open.

Sample Event Evaluation Form

Thank you for participating in the Inclusion Event. Please take a few moments to complete this evaluation. It will help us plan future events.

I am: (check all that apply):

- ☐ A person with a disability
- ☐ Parent of a child with a disability
- ☐ Clergy
- ☐ Educator
- ☐ Volunteer at a disability-related program
- ☐ Disability Professional
- ☐ Mental Health Professional
- ☐ Member of a Congregation
- ☐ Community Member
- ☐ Other _____

How did you hear about the Inclusion Event?

- ☐ Received an email notification from my local Friendship Circle
- ☐ Received an email from my local Chabad House
- ☐ Friend or family member
- ☐ Post in congregation newsletter
- ☐ Social media
- ☐ Newspaper article
- ☐ Saw the flyer posted
- ☐ From one of the vendors (please tell us who that was) _____
- ☐ Other _____

What did you enjoy most about the Inclusion Event? Check all that apply:

- ☐ Music videos
- ☐ Level the Playing Field group activity
- ☐ Guest Speaker (name)
- ☐ Disability Inclusion Etiquette video
- ☐ Keynote Speaker
- ☐ Inclusion Pledge Activity
- ☐ Dessert Reception
- ☐ Vendor displays and information
- ☐ The location

What would you change? Check all that apply:

- ☐ Music videos
- ☐ Level the Playing Field group activity
- ☐ Guest Speaker (name)
- ☐ Disability Inclusion Etiquette video
- ☐ Keynote Speaker
- ☐ Inclusion Pledge Activity
- ☐ Dessert Reception
- ☐ Vendor displays and information
- ☐ The location

What did you learn from this evening's presentations?

What could we improve upon?

Comments and/or suggestions?

Event Materials

Awareness Pledge Quilt Activity

Your Inclusion Event event can include an activity. One way to continue to remind people of the importance of including people with disabilities is to create an awareness pledge quilt. The quilt is easy to create and assemble. You can hang it in a prominent place so that everyone who enters your building can see it.

Suggested materials:

ALEX Toys Craft Knot a Quilt Kit (easy to assemble) and available on Amazon and other online stores.

<http://www.amazon.com/ALEX-Toys-Craft-Knot-Quilt/dp/B000F3V2R2>

CRAYOLA Fabric Markers, 80 count, available on Amazon and other online stores.

<http://www.amazon.com/Crayola-588215-Classpack-Assorted-different/dp/B0017DHP66>

Note: Permanent markers work just as well

Ask participants to each write on a piece of fabric something that they pledge to do to spread awareness and to include people with disabilities. After the event you can piece the quilt together to hang in a prominent location.

Alternate Awareness Pledge Activity

Like the Awareness Pledge Quilt, this activity encourages people to make a commitment following the event. It takes a little less time than creating the quilt.

You will need:

Notecards or sticky notes

Pens or pencils

Ask participants to write on the note card or sticky note something that they pledge to do to spread awareness and to include people with disabilities. Then ask each person to read his or her individual pledge aloud to the audience. Be sure to invite people to take their written pledges home with them.

Beyond Inclusion Event Ideas

How can you raise awareness about inclusion of people with disabilities in your community? Here are some other ideas that will boost awareness and make your Chabad House/Friendship Circle community a leader in supporting inclusion! Contact Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative (RCII) for information and assistance in planning your follow-up activities. info@rcii.org.

- As an outcome of your Inclusion Event, organize a disability inclusion committee to focus on making your Chabad House/Friendship Circle more inclusive.
- Create a community calendar of events that are open to the public.
- Visit the RCII Resource Hub for webinars and information on a variety of topics and training materials.
- Convene an inclusion roundtable with representatives from every Jewish organization that will meet regularly to discuss the needs and work toward building capacity in the community.
- Create a community Resource Guide of inclusive organizations.
- Choose a yearly inclusion theme such as “Person First.” Identify Jewish values that are relevant to the theme.